

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, freight automation.*

Positioning. I own complex operational product areas from discovery to measurable outcome, in B2B SaaS environments where the work is still mostly done by email and spreadsheet.

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Dear Zencargo team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role. I have 13 years owning product areas in operationally complex B2B SaaS environments, insurance, defence AI, public-sector analytics, healthcare, and payments, and the through-line in every role has been the same: take a process that runs on emails and spreadsheets, map it properly, find where technology reduces friction, and ship something measurable.

That description fits Zencargo's problem statement almost exactly. The posting names exception management, booking and shipment workflows, and purchase-order management as candidate areas. These are not abstract product domains; they are concrete operational processes where the gap between what the system can do and what users actually do is usually visible the moment you sit next to someone and watch. I have closed that kind of gap before: at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I instrumented two competing workflows and found the more polished one had zero real usage, the data-first path the team considered secondary was where all the work actually happened. That analysis redirected the entire development quarter.

On AI: I use Claude Code, Cursor, Lovable, and GPT daily as part of how I do discovery and prototyping, and I have shipped AI-powered features in production. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, managing a 15-person cross-functional team. I know the difference between AI features that reduce real operational load and AI features that look impressive in a demo. Luca sounds like the former, and I would rather help make that distinction clearly than add features for their own sake.

I do not have a background in freight forwarding specifically. My logistics knowledge comes from my Diplom-Wirtschaftsingenieur studies at TU Berlin, where logistics was my specialisation. The operational complexity, multiple parties, exception-heavy workflows, time-sensitive decisions with imperfect data, is familiar from defence programme coordination and public-sector data platforms. Domain gaps at the application layer close quickly when the underlying product skills are already there.

I am based in Berlin, available at four weeks' notice, and happy to work remotely or to discuss on-site arrangements. I would welcome a conversation about the specific product area and what the squad is currently focused on.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
